

Consolidated Q&A from Team Discussion

Q1) Do we need to add a speaker tag if only non-speech vocalizations (such as sighing, coughing, crying, or baby vocalizations) are present?

Ans) No. If the audio contains only non-speech vocalizations and no actual speech, a speaker tag is not required.

Q2) We are not familiar with languages such as Japanese, Spanish, or German, but the model generates keywords based on the audio. Should we keep the generated language labels, or should we modify them?

Ans) If speech is present and the language has been pre-identified by the model, you may review it to determine whether it appears accurate. If it seems correct, it can be left as is. However, if you are unable to confidently identify or verify the language, it should ideally be marked as unclear (or the appropriate equivalent label).

Q3) If live music is being played in the environment, we select Music Detected = Yes. However, if music is coming from a media source such as a TV, phone, computer, radio, or speaker, should we select both Music Detected = Yes and Media Sound Detected = Yes, or only Media Sound Detected = Yes?

Ans)

- If the music is being performed live within the recording environment, annotate Music Detected = Yes and Media Sound Detected = No.
- If the music is being played through a media source (e.g., TV, speaker, phone, computer, or radio), annotate Music Detected = Yes and Media Sound Detected = Yes.
- If the media source is playing non-music audio (e.g., dialogue or other sounds), annotate Music Detected = No and Media Sound Detected = Yes.

Q4) Can a mechanical hum be labeled as an engine sound when it resembles a loud engine noise?

Ans) If you can infer with confidence from the audio or using video as reference we can. Please check the full label list to see which ones are closest to engine sounds to use right taxonomy.

Q5) If no person is visible in the room, but voices (such as soft whispers) are audible, should a speaker tag be added?

Ans) Yes. If speech is audible, a speaker tag should be added regardless of whether the speaker is visible in the video.

Q6) How should we distinguish between a mechanical hum and an electrical hum, particularly when the sound is very faint? Should a faint continuous hum be annotated as a specific hum event or treated as ambient room noise?

Ans) Distinguishing between mechanical and electrical hums can be challenging.

- If the sound can reasonably be associated with equipment containing moving parts (such as an air conditioner, fan, pump, refrigerator, or washing machine), it should be labeled as a mechanical hum.
- If the source appears to be electrical infrastructure (such as a transformer or high-voltage power lines), it should be labeled as an electrical hum.
- In general, mechanical hums are more commonly associated with devices that contain moving components.

Q7) If a clip contains other sound events along with distant or unclear speech in the background, should it be labeled as Speech Present or No Speech?

Ans) If the speech is clear enough to be recognized without straining to hear it, it should be annotated as Speech Present. If the speech is too faint or indistinct to be confidently identified as speech, it should be ignored.

Q8) If one person is speaking and another person only responds with a brief vocalization such as "hmm," should the second person be counted as a speaker?

Ans) Yes. If one person is speaking and another person produces a vocal response such as "hmm," the second individual should also be counted as a speaker. Since speech is already present in the clip, annotate 2 speakers, with the second person's response treated as a non-speech vocalization.